

First day, 90 minutes

ONE CHANGE TO YOUR PLAN, AND WHY

Mingle before solo. At fourteen and fifteen the audience that matters is not you, it is the other four, and asked to present cold they give you their shortest answer and sit down. After the mingle they have already spoken English to everyone in the room. The stand-up still happens, all five, no opt out. The authority signal comes from every instruction given once, in English, with a time limit you enforce, not from exposure.

Your new opening task replaced two blocks rather than adding a third. The twelve questions on page 1 are the profile, and asking those same twelve questions round the room on page 2 is the mingle, so the generic Find Someone Who is gone. Same mechanic, real matches instead of invented ones, and twelve minutes saved.

Also: presentations are one minute, not ninety, and the 40-word message on page 7 is a fast-finisher only.

Run order

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT YOU DO
15:45 3 min	Open	Names on the board, yours included. Four rules, said once, in English, not negotiated: we speak English in this room, we use full sentences, phones in bags, everybody talks. Do not ask if they agree.
15:48 6 min	Tell me a bit about you page 1	Silent, seated, individual. Twelve questions, two or three words each. Tell them they will be asking these same questions round the room in a minute, so the answers should be true rather than clever. Help with vocabulary only.
15:54 14 min	Now find your people page 2	Everybody stands, chairs pushed back. Same twelve questions, asked to classmates, a name written whenever an answer is close to their own. Rule: at least one name from every person in the room, so nobody talks to one friend and stops. Demonstrate question 6 with the quietest-looking student first. Teach the match language off the page 2 box before they start, <i>Me too, So do I, Same here, Me neither</i> , and insist on it. Circulate, do not correct. Stop it while it is still noisy.
16:08 7 min	Build six lines page 3	They turn their page 1 answers into the six sentence frames. Line 6 names the classmate they matched with. This is your writing sample, it stays in the booklet.
16:15 4 min	Rehearse in pairs page 3	Each says all six lines to one partner, partner gives one piece of advice, then swap. Nobody presents without having said it out loud once. At this age this step is what prevents the freeze.
16:19 11 min	Stand and deliver page 3	All five, standing, at the front. One minute each, not more. Six lines is roughly 45 seconds, so close it while they are still talking. Listeners complete the grid. Two questions from the floor after each. You go first. If someone dries up: ask one of three prepared questions instead of waiting. Where exactly in Valencia? What do you do at the weekend? Who taught you that? Never let the silence run.
16:30 7 min	Common ground page 4	Whole class, standing or in a circle. Three things true of all six of you, including you. Obvious answers rejected, they must agree out loud, and the three go on the board and stay there. Then each writes their Task 7 sentence, who they have most in common with and why.
16:37 28 min	Level Ladder pages 5 to 7	Same booklet, no second handout. Seated, silent, individual. One sentence of explanation: not an exam, covers the whole year. If you are behind , stop at Part 4 and finish it next Wednesday. Never cut the stand-up or the rehearsal.
17:05 8 min	Close	They write their December goal on page 4, you collect the whole booklet and hand it back in December. Show them the book: Unit 1 is Perfect for the job.

Who is confident, and who is not

HOW TO USE THIS

Fill it in during the stand-up, not afterwards. You are recording behaviour, not marking English. A student who speaks for 90 seconds in poor English is more use to you this year than one who says four perfect sentences and sits down. Quiet and unwilling need opposite treatment, so keep them apart in your notes.

During the presentations

STUDENT	1	2	3	4	5
Name					
How long they spoke					
Read every word, or looked up?					
Voice reached the back?					
Answered a question					
Asked someone a question					
Needed prompting					
Quiet, or unwilling?					

During the mingle, which is where the truth usually is

STUDENT	1	2	3	4	5
Started, or waited?					
Asked follow-ups					
Switched to Spanish when stuck					
Gravitated towards?					

Decide before you leave the room

Strongest speaker, and who to pair them with so they are not the class translator?	
Who spoke least, and the smallest thing they will definitely manage next Wednesday?	
Which two found something in common, and can that pairing carry into Unit 1?	
Anyone you need to sit apart?	

Line 6 is the one that builds the class. Every presentation ends by naming another student, so five presentations means five public connections between people who were strangers an hour earlier. Do not let anyone skip it.

Feeds into Unit 1. Task 1 question 3 is present simple habit, question 4 is present continuous, question 11 is jobs and question 12 is personality adjectives. That is the Unit 1 syllabus, produced by them in their own words before they open the book.

The Level Ladder, key and diagnosis

WHAT THIS IS MEASURING

Six parts, one per unit of New Close-up B1 Split A. The class has not studied any of it yet, so a low total is expected and is not the point. Each part is four grammar items they could plausibly have met at school and two vocabulary items from the unit's own word list. The grammar scores tell you what you can move through quickly. The vocabulary scores are only a rough signal, since the book's glossary is new to them.

Answer key, 36 marks

	ANS	UNIT	WHAT IT TESTS		ANS	UNIT	WHAT IT TESTS
1	works	1	present simple, habit	19	which	4	defining relative, thing
2	is sleeping	1	present continuous, now	20	whose	4	possessive relative
3	like	1	stative verb, not continuous	21	which	4	non-defining relative
4	is taking	1	continuous, temporary	22	as soon as	4	time clause, present for future
5	architect	1	jobs	23	leather	4	materials
6	reliable	1	personality adjectives	24	receipt	4	shopping
7	ate	2	past simple, irregular	25	are going to	5	be going to, decided plan
8	was cooking	2	past continuous, interrupted	26	I'll	5	will, spontaneous offer
9	was chopping	2	two past continuous actions	27	is going to	5	going to, present evidence
10	used to	2	used to, past habit	28	am seeing	5	present continuous, arrangement
11	sour	2	taste adjectives	29	wardrobe	5	household objects
12	pour	2	cooking verbs	30	move	5	home expressions
13	have / been	3	present perfect, never	31	boils	6	zero conditional
14	have lived	3	present perfect with since	32	wins	6	first conditional
15	have been looking	3	present perfect continuous	33	unless	6	unless
16	an	3	articles	34	had	6	second conditional
17	glacier	3	geographical features	35	helmet	6	sports equipment
18	renewable	3	climate change	36	coach	6	sports people

Marks that are worth a second look. Q26 and Q27 both look like futures but split on offer versus evidence, and Q28 is an arrangement, so a student who puts *will* in all three has one rule, not three. Q13 and Q14 separate present perfect from past simple, which is the single most common Spanish-speaker error in this book. Q34 is the only question above the Split A syllabus, since second conditional appears at the end of Unit 6, so treat it as a bonus rather than a gap.

Who knows what

Marks by unit, 6 per unit

UNIT	STUDENT 1	STUDENT 2	STUDENT 3	STUDENT 4	STUDENT 5
Name					
1 Perfect for the job (Q1 to 6)					
2 Delicious! (Q7 to 12)					
3 It's natural (Q13 to 18)					
4 That's the fashion (Q19 to 24)					
5 Where we live (Q25 to 30)					
6 Go for it! (Q31 to 36)					
TOTAL / 36					
Wrote the extra message? (fast finishers)					

Reading a single unit column

SCORE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR THAT UNIT	WHAT TO DO
5 or 6	They already have the grammar. The unit will be revision plus new vocabulary.	Move fast through the grammar pages, spend the time on the exam task and the speaking.
3 or 4	Partly there, usually the form but not the choice between two tenses.	Teach normally. Add one contrast drill on the pair they confused.
0 to 2	New. Do not assume any of it.	Budget a full extra session. Start from meaning, not from the rule.

Reading the total

/ 36	WHERE THEY ARE
28 to 36	Well above where the book starts. They will need extension work, or the class will bore them. Use the Extra Tasks Extension sheets in the source pack.
20 to 27	Solid B1 entry. The book is correctly pitched for them.
12 to 19	A2 plus, which is normal for the start of 3º ESO. The book will stretch them, which is the point.
0 to 11	Below the book's entry point. Check whether they were guessing at random, then plan A2 consolidation alongside Unit 1.

After marking, answer these three

Which unit scored lowest across the whole class?	
Which student is furthest ahead, and what will you give them?	
Which student is furthest behind, and what is the first thing to fix?	

Timing. The run sheet on page 1 governs the lesson. The Ladder runs 16:37 to 17:05, seated and silent, and the 40-word message on booklet page 7 is for fast finishers only. Unit 1 starts next Wednesday on student's book page 5, teacher's book notes at PDF page 20 of *NewCloseUp_B1_TeachersBook_AllUnits.md*.